

THE DOUBLE CROSS

*"She gave her up to save her. Now they must stop
the man who stole both their lives."*

90-Minute Cable Movie of the Week | Crime Thriller / Emotional Drama

CONCEPT OVERVIEW

An ex-con living under FBI protection in Atlanta is forced back into the criminal underworld by a high-stakes cyber heist threatening the city's financial infrastructure. Her world shatters when she discovers the rookie agent assigned to her case is her long-lost daughter—raised and weaponized by the vengeful former lover she betrayed.

GENRE

Crime Thriller / Emotional Drama

FORMAT

90-minute Movie of the Week (Lifetime / BET+ / OWN / Hallmark Mahogany)

tone & style

Gritty, suspenseful, emotionally charged. Think *The Good Wife* meets *Ozark* with a Southern noir edge.



CHARACTERS & CASTING



JANINE "JAY" CARTER

40s

Former con artist turned witness-protected teacher. Hardened, brilliant, haunted. Forced to confront her past and the daughter she thought was lost.

Casting Options: Sanaa Lathan, Regina Hall, Taraji P. Henson



LENA HAYES

26

By-the-book FBI agent. Ambitious, idealistic, unknowingly walking into a trap set by her manipulative adoptive father.

Casting Options: Dominique Thorne, Keke Palmer, Lex Scott Davis



DARIUS VAUGHN

40s

Tech-savvy crime boss, Jay's former lover, and Lena's vengeful adoptive father. Cold, calculating, driven by betrayal.

Casting Options: Michael Ealy, Lance Gross, David Oyelowo

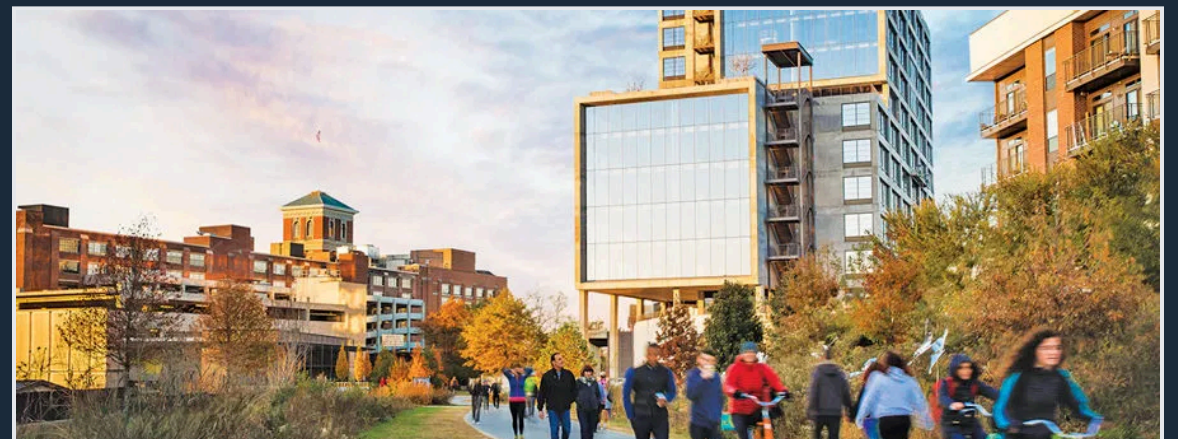
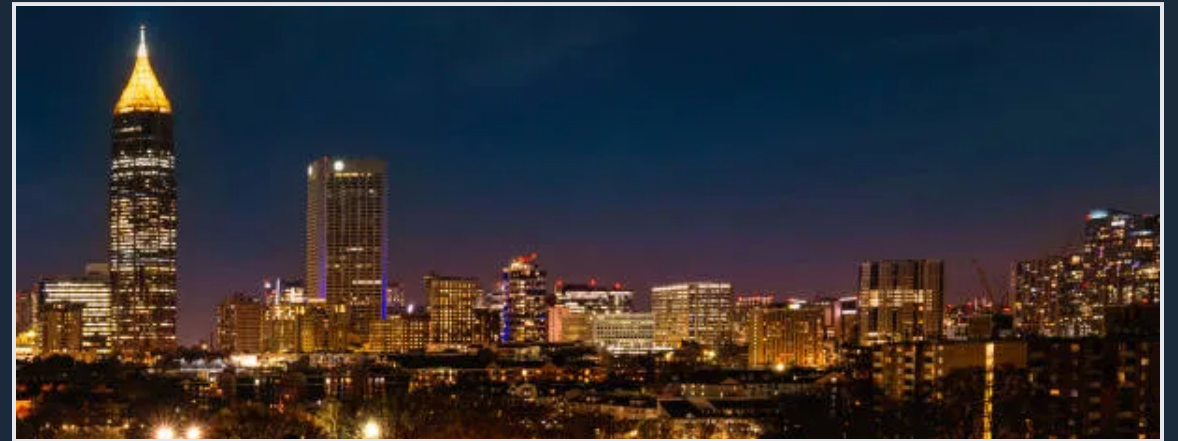
SETTING: ATLANTA, GA

Atlanta isn't just a backdrop—it's a character with its own contradictions and secrets.

KEY LOCATIONS

- **Sleek Midtown high-rises** - Where financial power players operate
- **Neon-lit Buckhead poker clubs** - Where Jay's past connections lurk
- **Gritty warehouses along the BeltLine** - Where the criminal underworld operates
- **Community centers, historic Fourth Ward churches** - Jay's new life as a teacher
- **Tech summits and financial towers** - Where the cyber heist threatens

The city's contrast between old Southern tradition and cutting-edge technology creates the perfect backdrop for a story about identity, legacy, and redemption.



PLOT SUMMARY

ACT I: THE SETUP

Janine "Jay" Carter has rebuilt her life as a respected community center teacher in Atlanta after a past life of crime. Under FBI witness protection for 15 years, she's haunted by the daughter she gave up to save from her dangerous ex-partner.

When a sophisticated cyber heist threatens Atlanta's financial infrastructure, Jay is approached by the FBI to help investigate due to her unique knowledge of the criminal underworld.

ACT II: THE CONFRONTATION

Jay is shocked to discover that the rookie FBI agent assigned to her case, Lena Hayes, is her long-lost daughter—now raised by Darius Vaughn, Jay's vengeful ex-partner whom she betrayed to the authorities.

As the cyber heist escalates into a full-blown economic war targeting Atlanta's financial system, Jay must navigate working with a daughter who doesn't know her true identity while outmaneuvering Darius's elaborate revenge plot.

ACT III: THE RESOLUTION

Mother and daughter must confront painful truths about their past while racing to stop Darius's attack on the city. As loyalties are tested and identities revealed, Jay and Lena forge an unlikely alliance to reclaim their stolen futures and find redemption in the most unexpected places.



KEY THEMES

- Redemption through sacrifice
- Identity and maternal legacy
- Reclaiming agency
- The cost of survival
- Vengeance vs. forgiveness

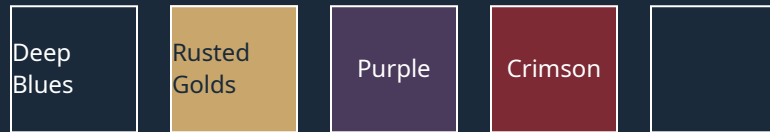
VISUAL STYLE & SOUND

CINEMATOGRAPHY

Neo-noir shadows with intimate camera work that brings viewers into the emotional core of scenes. Contrast between:

- Wide, establishing shots of Atlanta's skyline
- Tight, claustrophobic framing during tense moments
- Handheld sequences during action and emotional revelations

COLOR PALETTE

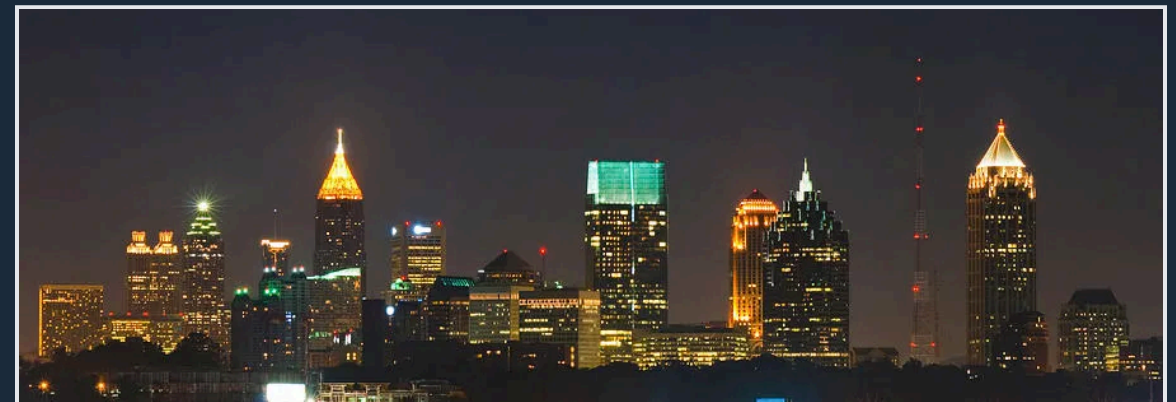
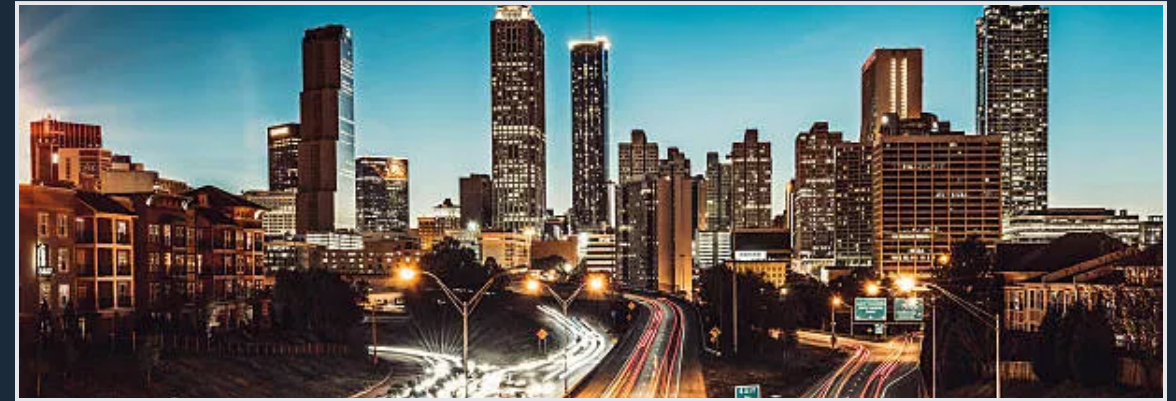


Humid Southern color palette that shifts between cool tones for FBI/tech scenes and warmer tones for emotional and character moments.

SOUND DESIGN

A layered soundscape that blends:

- Ambient Southern trap beats
- Noir jazz saxophone overlays
- Moody R&B instrumentals during emotional reveals
- Cinematic strings building tension



MOOD REFERENCES

- Queen & Slim meets Ozark
- The Equalizer meets Widows (2018)
- Emotional texture of Greenleaf with thriller pacing

SIMILAR SHOWS & TARGET AUDIENCE

COMPARABLE TITLES



The Good Wife

Legal drama with strong female lead



Ozark

Crime thriller with family dynamics



The Equalizer

Action drama with redemption arc



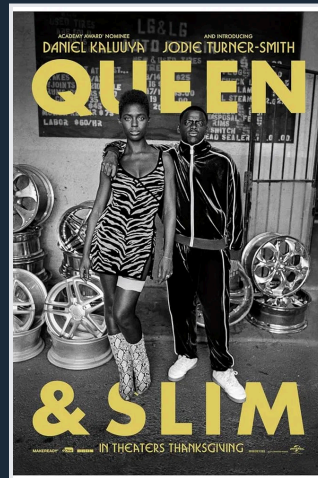
Widows

Female-driven crime thriller



Greenleaf

Southern family drama



Queen & Slim

Stylish thriller with emotional depth

TARGET AUDIENCE

Women 25–54, especially fans of:

- Greenleaf
- The Equalizer
- The Good Fight
- Fatal Attraction (2023)

WHY IT WORKS

- **Female-Driven, Emotionally Rich:** Mother-daughter relationship at the heart of the story
- **High Stakes + Personal Stakes:** Financial terrorism meets maternal redemption
- **Built-In Franchise Potential:** "The Double Cross Files" future spinoff/limited series
- **Atlanta as a Character:** A vibrant and layered backdrop full of visual energy

FRANCHISE POTENTIAL

THE DOUBLE CROSS FILES

A procedural spinoff with serialized emotion: Mother and daughter investigate new financial and digital crimes in each episode.

SERIES CONCEPT

Following the events of the movie, Jay and Lena form an unlikely partnership, combining Jay's street smarts with Lena's FBI training to tackle high-stakes financial crimes across Atlanta.

Each episode features a new case while the mother-daughter relationship evolves and past secrets continue to surface, creating ongoing emotional stakes.

EXPANSION OPPORTUNITIES

- **Limited Series:** 8-10 episode season exploring the aftermath of the movie's events
- **Anthology Series:** Each season focuses on a different "double cross" in various cities
- **Prequel Potential:** Jay's early life as a con artist and her relationship with Darius
- **Digital Content:** Character-focused webisodes exploring backstories



CORE THEMES

- **Legacy:** How our choices shape the next generation
- **Loyalty:** The complex bonds of family vs. professional duty
- **Justice:** Exploring the gray areas between legal and moral right
- **Redemption:** Finding purpose through unconventional means

BUILT FOR LONG-TERM ENGAGEMENT



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THANK YOU

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